Within .NET claims are represented by the `Claim` class. Among its properties are `Type`, `Value`, and `Issuer`. The last of these, the `Issuer`, is the authority that issued the claim. When you assign claims to users in your application, the issuer is `LOCAL_AUTHORITY`, by default. If you incorporate external authentication providers, like Google or Facebook, in your application, they will issue any claims they add to the identity they authenticate. You can choose which version of a claim to use, based on how much weight you give the issuer. For example, an external authentication service like Facebook may well prove an email claim, but the email address may not exist.

There is no limit imposed on what the `Type` represents. Widely used claim types are represented by URIs at the domain schemas.xmlsoap.org. It would be unreasonable to expect developers to use these URIs in their code, so for convenience, they are represented in .NET by a collection of constants in the `ClaimTypes` class. Table 10.1 shows the claim types you are most likely to find yourself working with.

Table 10.1 Commonly used claim types

Claim type	Description
`ClaimTypes.Name`	Represents the username of the user
`ClaimTypes.Email`	Used for the user's email address
`ClaimTypes.GivenName`	The user's first name
`ClaimTypes.Surname`	The user's last name
`ClaimTypes.NameIdentifier`	The user's unique identifier

When the user is authenticated in your application and has a `ClaimsIdentity` assigned to it, the authentication system adds